

Publication Ethics and Malpractice Statement

At **PeerCite Journals**, we are committed to maintaining the highest standards of publication ethics, transparency, integrity, and academic excellence. We follow internationally recognized ethical publishing practices to ensure the quality, originality, and credibility of the scholarly work we publish. All stakeholders—including authors, editors, reviewers, and publishers—are expected to adhere to the ethical principles outlined below.

1. Ethical Standards

PeerCite Journals is dedicated to:

- Promoting integrity and honesty in scholarly publishing.
- Ensuring transparency throughout the editorial and peer review process.
- Preventing plagiarism, data fabrication, falsification, duplicate publication, and unethical research practices.
- Protecting intellectual property rights and maintaining confidentiality.
- Providing fair, unbiased, and timely editorial decisions.

Responsibilities of Authors

Authors submitting manuscripts to PeerCite Journals must ensure that:

Originality

- Submitted work is original and has not been published or submitted elsewhere.
- Proper acknowledgment is given to the work of others through appropriate citations.

Plagiarism

- Any form of plagiarism, including self-plagiarism, is strictly prohibited.
- All manuscripts are screened using plagiarism detection software before peer review.

Data Integrity

- Research data must be accurate, authentic, and honestly reported.
- Fabrication, falsification, or manipulation of data is considered serious misconduct.

Multiple or Duplicate Submission

- Authors must not submit the same manuscript simultaneously to multiple journals.
- Duplicate publication is unacceptable.

Authorship

- Only individuals who have made substantial scholarly contributions should be listed as authors.
- All authors must approve the final manuscript before submission.

Conflicts of Interest

- Authors must disclose any financial, institutional, or personal conflicts of interest that could influence their research.

Ethical Approval

- Research involving human participants or animals must comply with applicable ethical standards and institutional guidelines.
- Authors must state that ethical approval and informed consent were obtained where applicable.

Corrections

- Authors are responsible for promptly informing the journal if significant errors are discovered after publication.

Responsibilities of Editors

Editors shall:

- Evaluate manuscripts solely on academic merit.
- Maintain confidentiality throughout the editorial process.
- Ensure fair and unbiased editorial decisions.
- Select qualified independent reviewers.
- Avoid conflicts of interest.
- Take appropriate action when ethical concerns or misconduct are identified.
- Issue corrections, retractions, or expressions of concern when necessary.

Editors shall not discriminate based on race, gender, nationality, religion, political beliefs, or institutional affiliation.

Responsibilities of Reviewers

PeerCite Journals follows a **double-blind peer review** process.

Reviewers are expected to:

- Conduct objective, constructive, and professional reviews.
- Maintain strict confidentiality.
- Review manuscripts within the agreed timeframe.
- Identify relevant published work not cited by the authors.
- Report suspected plagiarism, duplicate publication, or research misconduct.
- Disclose any conflicts of interest and decline review where impartiality cannot be maintained.

Reviewers must not use unpublished information obtained through peer review for personal benefit.

Responsibilities of the Publisher

PeerCite Journals is committed to:

- Supporting editorial independence.
- Maintaining ethical publishing standards.
- Preserving the integrity of the scholarly record.
- Investigating allegations of publication misconduct.
- Publishing corrections, retractions, or notices when appropriate.
- Continuously improving editorial quality and publishing practices.

Commercial interests shall never influence editorial decisions.

Publication Misconduct

The following constitute publication misconduct:

- Plagiarism
- Self-plagiarism
- Data fabrication
- Data falsification
- Image manipulation
- Duplicate publication
- Citation manipulation
- Undisclosed conflicts of interest

- Ghost authorship
- Gift authorship
- Peer review manipulation

Any confirmed misconduct may result in:

- Immediate rejection of the manuscript
- Retraction of published articles
- Notification to the authors' institution or funding agency
- Temporary or permanent prohibition from future submissions

Complaints and Appeals

Authors may appeal editorial decisions by providing a detailed justification supported by evidence.

Complaints regarding editorial handling, peer review, publication ethics, or misconduct will be investigated fairly, confidentially, and promptly.

Retractions and Corrections

PeerCite Journals will publish:

- Corrections for minor errors that do not invalidate research findings.
- Retractions for unreliable findings, plagiarism, duplicate publication, or serious ethical violations.
- Expressions of concern while investigations are ongoing, when appropriate.

The integrity of the scholarly record will always be maintained.

Artificial Intelligence (AI) Policy

Authors using Artificial Intelligence (AI) tools must:

- Clearly disclose the use of AI-assisted technologies in manuscript preparation.
- Remain fully responsible for the accuracy, originality, and integrity of the submitted work.
- Verify all AI-generated content before submission.

Copyright and Licensing

Authors retain responsibility for ensuring they have permission to reproduce copyrighted materials.

Published articles will be distributed according to the journal's licensing and copyright policies.

Confidentiality

All manuscripts, reviewer reports, editorial correspondence, and author information are treated as confidential throughout the submission, review, and publication process.

Commitment to Ethical Publishing

PeerCite Journals is committed to fostering responsible research, ethical publishing practices, and academic integrity. We continually review and strengthen our editorial policies to align with internationally recognized publishing standards and best practices, ensuring the trust and confidence of our authors, reviewers, readers, and the global research community.